strengthened coalitions with nonstate actors, such as local governments and private organizations, to fill the void left by US nonparticipation (Dijkstra et al. 2022). European countries took on leadership roles in global climate efforts.[87] The EU ramped up its Paris commitments with initiatives like the European Green Deal, which set a target of net-zero emissions by 2050. Additionally, the EU began incorporating compliance with the Paris Agreement as a condition in its trade agreements and lobbied other major emitters, including China, to uphold their commitments (Schuette and Dijkstra 2023). China, for its part, has emerged as a global leader on climate change mitigation and renewable energy.[88]

Efforts to bypass the Trump administration extended to engaging subnational actors and civil society within the United States. The UNFCCC launched initiatives like the Lima-Paris Action Agenda and the Momentum of Change Initiative, encouraging local governments, businesses, and NGOs to take the lead on climate action.[89] These efforts inspired the "We're Still In" movement, wherein states, cities, and corporations (including 3,900 CEOs) across the United States pledged to uphold the goals of the Paris Agreement despite the federal withdrawal.[90] This grassroots mobilization underscored a broader commitment to climate action within the United States, even as the federal government resisted.

In the short term, these strategies succeeded in keeping the Paris Agreement alive. The agreement continued to function, with global momentum sustained through the leadership of the EU and other key actors. When President Biden assumed office in 2021, the United States re-entered the agreement, restoring its role as a central player in global climate governance.

However, longer-term challenges remain. *The Economist* has warned of a growing transnational populist backlash against climate policies, fueled by the perception that green initiatives are imposed undemocratically by elites, infringing on national sovereignty.[91] While the international community's efforts to circumvent Trump preserved the Paris Agreement during his first term, the failure to directly confront these populist concerns left the door open for future resistance, threatening the sustainability of global climate efforts.